

AHMET ERGURUM

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Education

University of Wisconsin–Milwaukee

PhD in Political Science

Milwaukee, Wisconsin

2022–May 2027 (Expected)

Bilkent University

MA in International Relations

Ankara, Turkey

2020–2022

Bilkent University

BA in International Relations

Ankara, Turkey

2015–2020

Dissertation

Why Coercion Fails?

Committee: John Reuter, Shale Horowitz, Natasha Sugiyama

This dissertation examines why coercive threats often fail even when sender states possess substantial material leverage. It argues that coercive outcomes depend not only on capabilities and resolve, but also on how signals are produced within the sender state, transmitted through political and media environments, and interpreted by target elites and audiences. The project connects international security, foreign policy, and authoritarian politics through a mixed-method research design.

Research and Teaching Fields

Primary Fields: International Relations, International Security, Foreign Policy Analysis

Secondary Fields: Authoritarian Politics, Technology Policy, International Conflict

Peer-Reviewed Articles

- Ergurum, Ahmet. 2025. “Hawkish Leaders and Foreign Policy: A Political Psychological Approach.” *International Political Science Review*. [Link](#).
- Ergurum, Ahmet. 2025. “The Transition from Quantitative to Computational Methods in Foreign Policy Analysis.” *International Relations*. [Link](#).
- Doğrul, Mürsel, and Ahmet Ergurum. 2021. “New Search for Cybersecurity in the Light of Blockchain’s Literature Expansion.” *Journal of Security Sciences*. [In Turkish]. [Link](#).

Under Review

- Gheorghe, Eliza, Ahmet Ergurum, and Mürsel Doğrul. “Caught in the Crossfire: Dual Coercion and Japan’s Semiconductor Strategy Amid U.S.–China Rivalry.” Under review.

Book Chapters

- Ergurum, Ahmet. “Mapping Emerging Technology Discourse in the Eastern Mediterranean: A Computational Text Analysis of United Nations Speeches.” In *Between Conflict and Cooperation in the Eastern Mediterranean, Volume II: Strategic Spaces and Regional Networks*. Springer. Accepted for publication.
- Ergurum, Ahmet. 2025. “Turkish Foreign Policy in a Multipolar World Order.” In *Non-Western Middle Powers in the Multipolar Order*. Routledge. [Link](#).
- Doğrul, Mürsel, Ahmet Ergurum, and Haydar Yalçın. 2024. “Technology Intelligence: Cryptocurrencies and Emerging Technologies.” In *Future-Oriented Technology Assessment: A Manager’s*

Guide with Case Applications. Wiley. [Link](#).

- Doğrul, Mürsel, Ahmet Ergurum, and Haydar Yalçın. 2024. “The Landscape Analyses of Semiconductor Research Trends of Middle Powers: Mapping the Collaboration Networks of Japan, South Korea, Türkiye, and Malaysia.” In *Global Transformations and Türkiye*. Turkish Academy of Sciences. [Link](#).

Reference Works / Invited Encyclopedia Entries

- BRICS in the Maghreb. *Oxford Research Encyclopedia of African History*. Oxford University Press, with Dana Abu-Haltam, forthcoming.

Policy Writing

- Ergurum, Ahmet. 2024. “How Do Armed Groups Shape the Sudan Civil War?” *Middle East Foundation*.
- Fidan, Ahmet, Bengisu Açıkgoz, and Ahmet Ergurum. 2019. “The Further Potential of Turkmenistan to Export Natural Gas to China.” *Bilkent Energy Notes*. [Link](#).

Working Papers

- “Middle Power AI Policy Amid Superpower Rivalry: The Case of UAE.” With Lawrence Rubin and Dana Abu Haltam.
- “Polarization and Threat Perceptions: Attitudes Toward Defense Spending in the United States.”
- “Emerging Technologies and International Security: A Computational Text Analysis of United Nations Security Council and General Assembly Speeches.”
- “Microfoundations of Strategic Culture: An Operational Code Approach.” With Özgür Özdamar.

Research in Progress

- “Semi-Supervised Machine Learning Analysis of Congressional Nuclear Rhetoric, 2021–2025.”
- “Leader Hawkishness and Military Spending: A Panel Data Analysis.”
- “Globalization and Networked Nuclear Proliferation.” With Eliza Gheorghe, Mürsel Doğrul, and Haydar Yalçın.

Edited Volume Project

- *Middle Powers and the Geopolitics of AI*. Editor. Book project under review.

Awards and Grants

- 2026. ICPSR Summer Program Scholarship, ICPSR Summer Program in Quantitative Methods (Data Science and Text Analysis; Causal Inference II), University of Michigan.
- 2026. Wilder Crane Memorial Scholarship, University of Wisconsin–Milwaukee.
- 2026. Travel Grant, International Studies Association Annual Conference.
- 2025. Research Grant, Institute for Humane Studies, George Mason University.
- 2025. Travel Grant, University of Wisconsin–Milwaukee.
- 2024. Jerome M. Clubb Scholarship, ICPSR Summer Program in Quantitative Methods, University of Michigan.
- 2024. Chancellor’s Award, University of Wisconsin–Milwaukee.

- 2024. Travel Grant, University of Wisconsin–Milwaukee.
- 2024. Research Fellowship, Middle East Foundation, Turkey.
- 2023. Fee Waiver and Housing Coverage, Summer Institute in Computational Social Science.
- 2023. Travel Grant, Cornell University Reppy Institute for Peace and Conflict Studies.
- 2023. Travel Grant and Chancellor’s Award, University of Wisconsin–Milwaukee.
- 2022. Developing Nations Scholarship, Midwest Political Science Association.
- 2022. Chancellor’s Award, University of Wisconsin–Milwaukee.
- 2020–2022. Full Scholarship/Stipend (MA), Bilkent University.
- 2019–2022. Fellowship, Ankara Center for Thought and Research (ADAM Derneği), Turkey.
- 2019. Scholarship, Sinan-Wren Foundation, International Media Training Programme.
- 2017. Scholarship, TIKA-Tunisia Ministry of Education, Experience Sharing Program, Volunteering, Tunisia.
- 2014. European Union Project Funding, “My Little Homeland” Erasmus+ Project, Poland.

Teaching Experience

Instructor of Record

University of Wisconsin–Milwaukee
Comparative Political Systems

Milwaukee, Wisconsin
Spring 2026

Teaching Assistant

University of Wisconsin–Milwaukee
Graduate Teaching Assistant, Department of Political Science

Milwaukee, Wisconsin
2022–Present

- Chinese Politics and Foreign Policy (Shale Horowitz)
- Nationalism and Ethnic Conflict (Shale Horowitz)
- The Politics of International Economic Relations (Shale Horowitz)
- Comparative Political Systems (Hong Min Park)
- Introduction to Global Studies I: People and Politics (Shale Horowitz)
- Latin American Politics (Natasha Sugiyama)
- Morality, Conflict and War (Kristin Trenholm)
- History of International Political Thought (Kristin Trenholm)
- Politics of World’s Nations (Kristin Trenholm)
- Introduction to American Government and Politics (Kathleen Dolan)
- Introduction to Political Science (Enes Ayash)

Courses Prepared to Teach

Introduction to International Relations; International Security; Foreign Policy; Comparative Politics; Authoritarian Politics; Technology and World Politics

Research Experience

Center for AI & Digital Policy (CAIDP)
Research Group Member, AI Policy Clinic

Online
January - April 2026

- Selected for CAIDP’s interdisciplinary AI Policy Clinic focused on AI policy analysis, research, and evaluation.

- Contributed to the Argentina country report for the AI and Democracy Values Index book.

University of Wisconsin–Milwaukee

Milwaukee, Wisconsin

Political Attitudes Lab - Co-PI

2024–2025

- Collected and analyzed survey data for the project “Religiously Unaffiliated Citizens and Democracy in the United States” under the supervision of Kyle McWagner.

Middle East Foundation

Ankara, Turkey

Research Fellow

July–August 2024

- Authored a policy report on armed groups in the Sudan civil war.
- Conducted interviews with Sudanese subject-matter experts and elites.

Grand Strategy of the U.S. and China: A Role Theory Approach

Remote

Research Assistant

October 2023–June 2024

- Coded presidential speech data to analyze U.S.–China foreign policy with a team of PhD researchers.

Bilkent University

Ankara, Turkey

Research Assistant

2021–2022

- Collected and analyzed archival material from nineteenth-century Ottoman chronicles to analyze great-power conflict decision-making.

Bilkent Energy Policy Research Center

Ankara, Turkey

Research Intern

2019

- Conducted statistical analyses on Turkmenistan’s natural gas reserves, fields, pipelines, and contracts.
- Analyzed alternative pipeline routes and regional foreign policy implications.

Ministry of Energy and Natural Resources

Ankara, Turkey

Intern

June 2018

- Translated energy news from Africa and authored a research report on Gazprom.

Conference Presentations

- **2026.** “How Middle Powers Navigate Great Power Rivalry? The Case of the UAE’s AI and 5G Policy.” With Lawrence Rubin and Dana Abu-Haltam. *International Studies Association Annual Convention, Columbus.*
- **2026.** “The Impact of U.S. Administrative Shifts on Middle Eastern Foreign Policy Amid U.S.–China Competition.” *International Studies Association Annual Convention, Columbus.*
- **2026.** “Networked Proliferation: Globalization, International Institutions, and the Spread of Nuclear Weapons.” With Eliza Gheorghe, Mürsel Doğrul, and Haydar Yalçın. *International Studies Association Annual Convention, Columbus.*
- **2026.** “From Smart Power to Spatial Transformation: Rethinking Regionalism in the Trump Era.” Roundtable participant. *International Studies Association Annual Convention, Columbus.*
- **2025.** “David Ben-Gurion and Moshe Sharett as Founders of Israeli Strategic Culture: An Operational Code Approach.” *International Studies Association Annual Convention, Chicago.*
- **2025.** “Polarization and Threat Perceptions: Attitudes Toward Defense Spending in the United States.” *ISA International Security Studies Section–International Security Studies Regional Conference, Washington, DC.*

- **2025.** “Emerging Technologies and International Security: A Computational Text Analysis of United Nations Security Council Speeches.” *ISA International Security Studies Section–International Security Studies Regional Conference, Washington, DC.*
- **2025.** “Emerging Technologies and International Security: A Computational Text Analysis of United Nations Security Council Speeches.” *Midwest Political Science Association Annual Conference.*
- **2025.** “Leader Hawkishness and Military Spending: A Panel Data Analysis.” *International Studies Association Annual Convention, Chicago.*
- **2024.** “Emerging Technologies and International Security: A Computational Text Analysis of United Nations Security Council Speeches.” *ISA Northeast Annual Conference, Baltimore.*
- **2024.** “Emerging Technologies and International Security: A Computational Text Analysis of United Nations Security Council Speeches.” *Cornell University Reppy Institute for Peace and Conflict Studies Conference.*
- **2024.** “Leader Hawkishness and Military Spending: A Panel Data Analysis.” *ISA Northeast Annual Conference, Baltimore.*
- **2023.** “Right-Wing Populism and Foreign Policy: An Operational Code Analysis.” *ISA Midwest Conference.*
- **2023.** “Right-Wing Populism and Foreign Policy: An Operational Code Analysis.” *Turkish Political Science Association Annual Conference.*
- **2023.** “Operational Code Analysis of Hawkish Leaders.” *Midwest Political Science Association Annual Conference.*
- **2023.** “David Ben-Gurion and Moshe Sharett as Founders of Israeli Strategic Culture: An Operational Code Approach.” *Midwest Political Science Association Annual Conference.*
- **2022.** “Do Advancements in the Defense Industry Lead the Same in Blockchain Literature?” With Mürsel Doğrul and Haydar Yalçın. *American Political Science Association (APSA) Annual Meeting.*

Professional Service

- Panel Chair and Discussant, International Studies Association Annual Conference, 2026.
- Technical Moderator, ISA 2025 Virtual Conference.
- Report Peer Reviewer and Language Editor, Turkish Academy of Sciences (TUBA), 2025.
- Panel Discussant, International Studies Association Annual Conference, 2025.
- Technical Moderator, ISA 2024 Virtual Conference.
- Conference Organization Committee Member, Turkish Academy of Sciences (TUBA), 2021.

Academic Journal Reviewer

- *Political Research Quarterly*
- *Global Studies Quarterly*
- *International Politics*
- *International Political Science Review*
- *Southeast European and Black Sea Studies*

Methods, Skills, and Languages

R	Data analysis, visualization, statistical modeling
Python	Pandas, Matplotlib
SQL	Data manipulation, MySQL, IBM Db2
Power BI	Data analysis and visualization
Qualtrics	Survey design
Languages	Turkish (native), English (professional proficiency), French (beginner)

Selected Methodological Training

- Emerging Methodologists Workshop (EMW), Syracuse University, 2026.
- ICPSR Summer Program in Quantitative Methods, University of Michigan, 2024.
- Summer Institute in Computational Social Science, 2023.
- Hertie School Data Science Lab, Data Science Summer School, 2021.
- IPSA–ABU Social Science Research Methods Summer School, 2021.

References

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Shale Horowitz

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shale@uwm.edu